

Niknaz Sadehvandi

Matthews, NC | 202-600-1591 | nikkisadvand@gmail.com | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/nikki-sadvand-a34179325/> | <https://github.com/Nikki-65>

SUMMARY

Cybersecurity graduate with hands-on experience in SIEM monitoring, Windows and network telemetry analysis, malware triage, MFA enforcement, and endpoint hardening. Built Elastic and Splunk lab environments using Sysmon, Zeek, Filebeat, Kibana, and KQL to practice alert triage, detection rule testing, and incident investigation. Seeking SOC internship, junior analyst, MDR/SOC Tier 1, or detection/monitoring roles.

CORE SKILLS

SIEM & Detection: Elastic Security, Splunk, Kibana, KQL, alert triage, detection rule testing

Telemetry & Logs: Sysmon, Windows Event Logs, Zeek DNS/HTTP, IIS logs, Filebeat

Security Operations: Threat hunting, malware analysis, incident documentation, vulnerability remediation, endpoint hardening

Tools & Platforms: Wireshark, Nmap, Autopsy, FTK Imager, Microsoft Defender, VirusTotal, Event Viewer, Windows, Linux, Active Directory

Frameworks & Scripting: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, NIST 800-53, PowerShell, Python, Bash

EXPERIENCE

Sunset Auto Sales | Matthews, NC | Mar 2019–Present

Cybersecurity & IT Support Technician

- Supported Windows endpoints in a small-business environment, handling malware triage, MFA setup/enforcement, account support, and endpoint troubleshooting.
- Helped reduce recurring malware issues by tightening endpoint settings, reinforcing MFA, and standardizing basic security hygiene.
- Assisted with vulnerability remediation, endpoint hardening, patching, and access updates to improve day-to-day security posture.
- Documented issues, remediation steps, and security-related changes to support follow-up and repeatable support workflows.

PROJECTS

Independent Security Projects & Home Lab | Remote | Dec 2024–Present

- Built a Fleet-managed Elastic lab using Sysmon, Filebeat, Kibana, and Windows telemetry to improve endpoint visibility and support investigations.
- Created and tested detection rules with Elastic Security, KQL, and Zeek DNS/HTTP logs to validate suspicious activity scenarios.
- Conducted alert triage and log analysis using Windows Event Logs, Sysmon, Splunk, and Kibana to investigate authentication and process anomalies.
- Wrote incident notes and remediation recommendations aligned with NIST security concepts.

Selected Projects

- Splunk SIEM Dashboarding & Alert Triage: Built dashboards for Windows Event IDs 4624, 4625, and 4688 to investigate login anomalies and suspicious process execution.
- Network Asset Discovery & Security Reporting Automation: Built a Python wrapper for Nmap to automate scan execution and produce structured reports for security analysis.
- DFIR & Incident Investigation Labs: Analyzed IIS logs, PowerShell activity, Base64 payloads, endpoint artifacts, and network captures using Wireshark, Autopsy, and FTK Imager.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Kafpoush | Oct 2011–Feb 2016

IT Administrator / Helpdesk

- Performed malware remediation, patching, access updates, and routine system checks to support secure daily operations.

Ganjineh | Oct 2008–Jul 2010

Technical Assistant

- Installed and supported CCTV, access control systems, and basic network infrastructure; performed troubleshooting and routine maintenance.

EDUCATION

University of Maryland Global Campus

M.S., Cybersecurity Technology | GPA: 4.0

University of Phoenix

B.S., Information Technology | Magna Cum Laude

Central Piedmont Community College

A.A., Information Technology

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ — In Progress; exam voucher purchased, currently studying

Additional Training: IBM Python Basics for Data Science | Stanford Online R Programming Fundamentals